

precommit_wiring

Pre-commit semgrep wiring — exact change

Constitution: §11.4.166(3) — pre-commit semgrep scan --config auto --error blocks the commit on any finding. §11.4.28/§11.4.35 — invoke the constitution reference hook by reference, never copy it.

Date: 2026-06-22 **Target hook:** /Volumes/T7/Projects/helix_code/.git/hooks/pre-commit **Reference script (already shipped, executable):** constitution/scripts/hooks/semgrep_precommit.sh

NOT applied by the onboarding agent (live-hook edit + meta-git race avoidance). The conductor/operator applies this.

Current state (FACT)

The live .git/hooks/pre-commit is **NOT** a semgrep hook — it is the guard-forbidden-commands.sh PreToolUse-style guard (§11.4.109). It currently has **zero** semgrep reference. The semgrep wiring **MUST** be **ADDITIVE**: it must not remove or weaken the existing guard. Two options:

Option A — append a sourcing block to the existing pre-commit (RECOMMENDED)

The existing hook ends with:

```
# -----  
# Nothing matched (or only allow-marked warnings fired) → allow  
#   the command.  
# -----  
exit 0
```

The guard hook is set -euo pipefail and ends in exit 0, so a new block must run **before** that final exit 0. Replace the trailing exit 0 with a call into the semgrep reference hook, so its exit code governs the commit:

```
# -----  
# §11.4.166(3) – semgrep static-analysis gate (additive). Runs  
#   the constitution
```

```
# reference hook by reference (§11.4.28/§11.4.35 – never copied).
    It is
# graceful-degrading (skips cleanly when semgrep is absent) and
    blocks the
# commit (exit 1) only when `semgrep scan --config auto --error`
    finds issues.
# -----
_SEMGREP_HOOK="$(git rev-parse --show-toplevel)/constitution/
    scripts/hooks/semgrep_precommit.sh"
if [ -x "$_SEMGREP_HOOK" ]; then
    "$_SEMGREP_HOOK" || exit 1
fi

exit 0
```

(Place this block immediately before the existing final `exit 0`, replacing that single trailing `exit 0` line. The guard's own earlier `exit 2/exit 0` paths are untouched — only the fall-through “allow” path now additionally runs semgrep.)

Caveat (§11.4.6): the existing guard runs under `set -euo pipefail`. The `"$_SEMGREP_HOOK" || exit 1` form is `-e`-safe (the `||` consumes the non-zero). Do NOT write a bare `"$_SEMGREP_HOOK"` line — under `-e` a non-zero from the reference hook would abort with the hook's own exit code rather than the intended `exit 1`, which is acceptable but less explicit.

Option B — wire via `scripts/install_git_hooks.sh` (if the project uses a hook installer)

If the project installs hooks through a chained installer (`scripts/install_git_hooks.sh` per §11.4.75), register `constitution/scripts/hooks/semgrep_precommit.sh` as an additional pre-commit stage there instead of hand-editing `.git/hooks/pre-commit`, so a hook re-install does not drop the semgrep stage. Prefer this if the installer exists.

Exact one-liner (if a minimal in-place edit is preferred)

If the operator wants the smallest possible change and accepts running semgrep inline (rather than via the reference hook), insert before the final `exit 0`:

```
git diff --cached --name-only --diff-filter=ACM \
| grep -E '\.(py|js|ts|go|java|kt|rb|c|cpp|h|hpp|ya?ml|json|sh|
bash)$' \
| { read -r _f && { echo "$_f"; cat; } | xargs -r semgrep scan
--config auto --error || exit 1; }
```

RECOMMENDED is Option A — it reuses the constitution reference hook (graceful degradation, staged-file filtering, evidence messaging already built in) per §11.4.28/§11.4.74 (reuse-don't-reimplement).

Apply checklist (conductor)

1. `cd /Volumes/T7/Projects/helix_code`
2. Confirm reference hook is executable: `test -x constitution/scripts/hooks/semgrep_precommit.sh && echo OK`
3. Edit `.git/hooks/pre-commit`: replace the single trailing `exit 0` with the Option-A block above.
4. Verify: stage a file with a known finding and attempt a commit — it **MUST** be blocked with `[semgrep-precommit] SEMGREP FOUND ISSUES – COMMIT BLOCKED`. Stage a clean file — commit **MUST** proceed.
5. Confirm the guard hook still fires (e.g. a `sudo Bash` call is still blocked).

Sources verified 2026-06-22

- `constitution/scripts/hooks/semgrep_precommit.sh` (read this session)
- `.git/hooks/pre-commit` live content (read this session)
- Constitution §11.4.166(3); §11.4.28/§11.4.35/§11.4.74/§11.4.75